EPISODE 01

1 INT. DINGY MOTEL - NIGHT 1

A motel room so rundown and dirty the cockroaches don't stay. SHANNON CLARK (29) lies sick in bed, coughing. She weakly reaches for a glass of water sitting on a warped nightstand carved up with graffiti.

Shannon strains to reach the water. Too weak.

KAREN MURPHY (28), uptown glam and loathe to be in a place so dirty, pushes open the door and steps inside. Her fiance, RICKY TRAX (29), sporting a tailored suit that oozes "powerful businessman...wannabe" follows Karen like a nervous puppy.

Karen reaches for the glass of water and "accidentally" knocks it over. Shannon collapses in exhaustion.

KAREN
Whoops.

Karen covers her mouth and giggles like a bitch. She links arms with Ricky, showing off her engagement ring, of which the dazzling shine pierces through Shannon's heart.

KAREN (cont'd)
Tomorrow, we are getting married. As my ex-best friend, I believe you want to give us your blessing, right?

SHANNON
Blessing? Fine. (coughs) Can I have some of my money back? My treatment isn't covered by...

KAREN
Shannon, how did you end up so shameless? Did you plan to feed off of Ricky your whole life?

Ricky nervously adjusts his suit over and over. He doesn't like being here, but he's not about to say no to Karen.

SHANNON
Ricky, before I trusted you with my fortune, you were the son of my father's chauffeur...who's feeding off who?

Ricky scowls and shoves Karen out of the way. He reaches over and grabs Shannon by the throat, half-lifting her out of the bed.

His grip tightens and tightens...

RICKY
You think I'm feeding off of YOU? Your father has been dead for years. Before you had me, you were a loser about to drop out of college. I earned my worth with blood and sweat tutoring dumb rich kids like you. You're nothing but the daughter of a filthy rich dead guy!

...until he flings her back to the bed.

SHANNON
You said you would marry me, not her, if I gave you control of the business. I'm asking you for less than one-percent of what I gave you.

Karen stifles laughter. Ricky rolls his eyes. Shannon collapses in a fit of tears and coughing.

EPISODE 02

2 INT. DINGY MOTEL - NIGHT 2

Ricky leans to get into Shannon's face, to be intimidating, but when he sees how sick she is, he recoils in disgust.

RICKY
How dare you even to bring that up? I saved the Clark family business from YOU, the useless, spoiled brat, who'd been carrying HIV, and never bothered to tell ME UNTIL THE NIGHT BEFORE OUR WEDDING!

SHANNON
I DIDN'T KNOW!

RICKY
How many people did you sleep with? How many excuses do you still have?

With a broken heart, Shannon is no longer listening.

SHANNON
Ricky, did you ever love me?

A beat. Ricky is stunned by the audacity of her question. Ricky and Karen burst out laughing. Shannon is devastated.

RICKY
Love? What an insult. Being stuck with a woman so stupid, disgusting and phony, looking back, everyday was like a nightmare. How can I love someone who only makes me sick?

Shannon grips her chest, coughing. Wet, nasty coughs. Disgusted, Ricky walks out, leaving Karen to deliver the final blow.

KAREN
Aw, look at you, here at the end and the only thing you want to know is if Ricky loved you. You should be asking how a drug-free virgin like you ended up with AIDS.

SHANNON
You know...?

KAREN
Since you're about to die. I'll have some mercy and tell you a little secret. Someone was hired to inject you with HIV. I'm surprised you never figured that out, or jumped off a building, to save the world from your disgrace.

SHANNON
Who would do that...why?

KAREN
Ricky. The love of your life didn't want to marry you. Twenty dollars to a junkie, he's free and you're the dirty slut. Nice and easy.

Horrified, Shannon pushes herself off the bed as Karen leaves, trying to stop her.

SHANNON
No, that can't be true. No...

Shannon gurgles and chokes, coughs spraying blood.

3 EXT. DINGY MOTEL - NIGHT 3

Karen and Ricky walk out of the hotel. They slow down when they see JOHNNY WONDER (30), a handsome, kind looking man hurrying towards the motel. All three eye each other when they pass shoulders. There is history there.

4 INT. DINGY MOTEL - NIGHT 4

Johnny kicks open the door and finds Shannon fallen halfway out of bed, unable to get up.

JOHNNY
Shannon!

He rushes to help as she coughs up more blood.

EPISODE 03

5 INT. DINGY MOTEL - NIGHT 5

Johnny rushes to Shannon's side and pulls her close. She coughs blood all over his suit.

JOHNNY
You need a doctor. Let me call 911...

SHANNON
Johnny Wonder...is it really you?

She looks longingly into his eyes, stops him from calling.

SHANNON (cont'd)
It's too late.

JOHNNY
I'm so sorry, Shannon. I always thought you were doing well...happily married. If I had any idea it was like this...I would have stopped the wedding! I'd have taken you from Ricky Trax! Let me call an ambulance, please?

Shannon smiles, almost laughing out of joy. Johnny is confused. Why is she laughing while dying?

SHANNON
I've never imagined, other than my father, there can be another man who cares so much about me. What a shame I wasted this life on a heartless monster. I'm a fool.

Shannon, coughing more blood, has her eyes rolling back. She can barely keep her head upright.

SHANNON (cont'd)
In my next life, I will...choose differently...

Shannon is breathing her last breath hearing:

JOHNNY
In my next life, I will make you the happiest woman in the world.

Tears falling down Johnny's face -- the last thing Shannon sees before she dies in his arms.

Then, in an instant we are transported to...

6 INT. COLLEGE CLASSROOM - DAY 6

A college classroom. Bright golden summer sunlight pours through a wall of windows. Desks are gleaming and every STUDENT in the room (including Shannon) wears casual clothes that cost thousands of dollars. Shannon is sleeping on her desk.

JOHNNY (V.O.)
(grieving as she dies)
Shannon...Shannon...SHANNON!

Shannon's eyes jolt open. She slowly lifts her head, unsure of where she is. Unsure why she's alive. Then she sees the name of her UNIVERSITY on a banner in the classroom.

SHANNON (V.O.)
This is...college? How can this be? I've been reborn ten years ago?

Shannon (18) looks around and sees Ricky (19) and Karen (18) sitting next to each other one table away. Clearly a couple.

RICKY
What’s wrong, honey?

KAREN
The egg-salad gave me a tummy ache.

Ricky looks at the lunch in front of Karen, then looks at Shannon who's still looking around the room in wonder.

RICKY
(to Karen)
I'll be right back.

Ricky walks over to Shannon.

Shannon feels food coming from above: Ricky has dumped Karen's lunchbox on top of Shannon's head. Shannon is stunned. Frozen. Giggles everywhere.

RICKY (cont'd)
I told you to get some FOOD for Karen, not the garbage people like you eat. Go buy something edible.

Shannon stares at Ricky, her face a cool, collected mask of rage. It unnerves Ricky to his core.

EPISODE 04

7 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 7

Shannon wipes egg-salad from her face.

SHANNON (V.O.)
Ricky Trax, in my previous life, I gave you everything, only for you to betray and murder me. This time will be different.

RICKY
Are you deaf? Go! Now!

KAREN
Ricky. Maybe I'd better go myself.

Karen gives a pouty, simpering vibe that is pure condescension. Ricky raises his palm to stop Karen.

RICKY
Why bother? Running errands for you makes her feel valued, right Shannon?

SHANNON (V.O.)
Yes. Let this meal start my revenge.

Shannon stands up and walks out so purposefully Ricky smugly thinks his world is in order.

8 INT. DINING HALL - DAY 8

The dining hall is impressive, like if The Cheesecake Factory wasn't tacky. While Shannon picking up food, Yancey (18), a classmate struts up beside her ready to cause trouble.

YANCEY
Fetching lunch for your master again? With brilliant girls like Karen around, Ricky won't waste a glance on your kind. You know that right?

Other STUDENTS watch the show, giggling behind their hands.

SHANNON
What kind am I?

YANCEY
The "daughter of his maid" kind. The "follows him to school every day" kind. The "dream of marrying rich" kind. The "if your lucky you can make his bed, sweep his floors, scrub his toilet" kind. You know. Your kind.

SHANNON
That's what Ricky told you? Did he tell you "his luxury car" belongs to MY family? That he's the son of MY driver?

The crowd watching gets bigger, laughs a little louder. It doesn't phase Shannon at all.

YANCEY
What a psycho! Barking like a chihuahua just because Ricky won't look at you? Hurry up, your master's lunch is getting cold.

SHANNON (V.O.)
The driver's son saying I'm HIS maid! Ricky Trax, you are going to pay for that.

Shannon takes her food and walks through the crowd that was watching and laughing. They all turn away in embarrassment.

EPISODE 05

9 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 9

Shannon sits at her desk, finishing up the food she was supposed to bring to Ricky and Karen.

Karen, Ricky and Yancey walk in, seeing the empty containers in front of Shannon.

RICKY
I told you to bring food for Karen and you ate it? Mine too? God, you're such a pig.

Shannon tosses her fork and knife down, and crosses her arms. She's done with this dude.

SHANNON
I bought this with my money. Two meals or twenty meals what does it have to do with you?

YANCEY
Your money? Even if you spend it, it's still Trax money. Duh.

SHANNON
What do you think, Ricky Trax? Who's money is it?

RICKY
I think getting lunch when you're told to get lunch for your boss is a simple task.

He leans over and whispers loudly in her ear.

RICKY (cont'd)
If someone can't get that right, she's gotta be stupid.

SHANNON
Who's my boss? Her? If this capable young woman is too lazy to get her own lunch, she deserves a tummy ache.

RICKY
You—

YANCEY
You're a Trax family maid. Taking care of his girlfriend is your job. Why is that so hard to comprehend?

Ignoring Yancey, Shannon rises to her feet and faces Ricky.

SHANNON
Ricky Trax. Am I your maid?

Ricky flinches. He's not used to direct confrontation like this.

RICKY
Alright, Shannon, alright. I'm not interested in this little game you're playing. Don't cause trouble because I won't forgive you. No matter how much you beg me.

SHANNON
Beg you? Why would I? What have I done wrong?

A stand-off. Ricky scoffs and rolls his eyes.

RICKY
You think you're tough? Fine, there's no seat for you in my car. You can walk home.

Everyone walks out, and Shannon watches them go.

SHANNON (V.O.)
Your car? It was never yours and it's time you learned your place.

EPISODE 06

10 EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - DAY 10

Shannon, with her handbag, walks toward a luxury car in front of everyone. She gets in the backseat, leaving them in awe. Yancey and her friends loudly gossip. The window is down.

YANCEY
After insulting Ricky and Karen she still has the nerve to keep freeloading rides? Unbelievable!

Yancey and her minions scoff. SUE (18), a student who socially clings to Yancey the way Yancey socially clings to Karen, chimes in.

SUE
A maid's daughter acting like a princess.

YANCEY
Ricky is too kind. If it was me, I'd have already kicked her out.

11 INT. CAR - DAY 11

Hearing their words, Shannon rolls up the window. Trying to relaxes, she closes her eyes.

SHANNON
Drive.

The driver, MR. TRAX (50) Ricky's father turns around to address Shannon. He's in a suit, but a cheap one.

MR. TRAX
Let's wait for Ricky.

SHANNON
Mr. Trax, you work for my father and me. I decide who we wait for.

MR. TRAX
Did you have a fight with him or something? I'll have a word with Ricky, for sure. But try to be nicer to him, if you please. I know you look down on us, but...

SHANNON
Drive! I don't want him in my car. I don't want him in my house. I don't want to see him anymore!

MR. TRAX
Well, let's wait.

SHANNON
Are you going to drive or not?

MR. TRAX (V.O.)
She's usually so scared of Ricky. What's going on today?
(MORE)

MR. TRAX (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Did she forget I'm her future father in law, or the fact my son will take over her father's business?

SHANNON
Mr. Trax I asked--

MR. TRAX
Look, they're coming out.

Shannon, fuming, sees Ricky and Karen walking out of the building toward the car. Mr. Trax hops out, deferential as hell, opening the door to the backseat for his son.

But when Ricky opens the door, Shannon grabs it and refuses to let Ricky inside. Panic flashes across Ricky's face.

EPISODE 07

12 INT./EXT. CAR - DAY 12

RICKY
(whispering)
Shannon what the hell are you doing?

SHANNON
You still expect a free ride in my car after insulting me like that?

Yancey and Sue watch from a distance, unable to hear what's being said, but willing to speculate anyway.

YANCEY
That's Ricky's family car. Why does he let this bitch do that to him?

SUE
That's what you get letting a maid's daughter ride with you. If you give a mouse a cookie...

YANCEY
C'mon Trax, just pull her out.

RICKY
Do you have to act like this? I forgive you about the lunch, but if you don't stop acting like this--

SHANNON
I don't need your forgiveness. You can walk home. Stop following me.

RICKY (V.O.)
I have to get in the car. Or I'll be exposed. If anyone knows I'm the son of their driver...

Ricky grabs Shannon's wrist and yanks her out of the car. Flinging her to the ground. He tosses her purse after her. The students laugh and cheer.

Ricky helps Karen in the back seat then he gets in front the other side. Nobody moves to help Shannon.

SHANNON
Ricky Trax, how dare you push me?

RICKY
Drive.

The car zooms away.

Shannon climbs to her feet, brushes off her purse and grabs her phone.

YANCEY
Well done Ricky, dealing with some ungrateful low life. That's what she deserved.

SUE
Ricky is so cool.

Shannon is on the phone.

SHANNON
Dad, our driver has forgotten who he works for.

YANCEY
Calling Ricky, begging for forgiveness? It's too late.

SHANNON
The one who will beg for forgiveness is him. Watch. My car is coming back.

Yancey laughs in disbelief. But her smile fades when the car engine roars as it reverses back to Shannon. Ricky, and Karen climb out. Mr. Trax is most chastised of all. Everyone who mocked Shannon are stunned.

MR. TRAX
Shannon, please get in the car. I'll take you wherever you want to go.

Shannon walks past Yancey and Sue proudly in vindication and gets into the backseat.

EPISODE 08

13 EXT. SCHOOL - DAY 13

Sue and Yancey watch the drama between Shannon, Ricky, and Mr. Trax play out in the parking lot.

SUE
Even Ricky's driver gets so respectful to a maid's daughter. This doesn't make sense.

YANCEY
Why did Ricky get out?

Mr. Trax clings to Shannon's door like it's a shield and timidly speaks over the top edge.

MR. TRAX
Shannon, was it really necessary to bother your father? For your little argument with Ricky? He's very busy.

SHANNON
From now on, they two are not allowed in this car.

MR. TRAX
Isn't that a little--childish, Shannon?

SHANNON
You are not close enough to use my name. Remember who pays you. I think to drive when your boss tells you to drive is a simple task. If you can't get that right, feel free to quit.

MR. TRAX
I...I know I was wrong. I'll drive right now.

Before his father closes the door, Ricky stops him.

RICKY
Shannon, that's enough.

SHANNON
Oh look, the "young master" is mad.

KAREN
Shannon, you may not like me, but there's no need to bully Ricky. He's always nice to you. He had the driver come back just for you. Why do you have to be so mean?

RICKY
No need to tell her that. She doesn't know anything about gratitude.
(MORE)

RICKY (CONT'D)
Shannon, you've really crossed the line this time.

Shannon rolls her eyes.

EPISODE 09

Shannon smiles with amusement.

SHANNON (V.O.)
Oh there is a line to cross? I had no idea. But, this is just the beginning. Ricky Trax, Karen....

She slams the door, almost crushing Ricky's hand, leaving him and Karen embarrassed. The window glides down --

SHANNON
Bye. (to Mr. Trax.) Driver, drive.

The car peels out.

14 EXT. SKYSCRAPER - NIGHT 14

Establishing shot of where Shannon lives.

15 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT 15

Shannon walks into the huge, open concept kitchen filled with natural light and spectacular views of the city. She finds an older woman, AUNT JO, preparing dinner. Jo takes her handbag.

AUNT JO
Miss, you're back alone? Where’s your friend Ricky?

SHANNON
Aunt Jo, from now on, I don't have any friends named Ricky.

AUNT JO
Miss, you’ve finally come to your senses.

With instant regret crossing the boundary, Aunt Jo covers her mouth awkwardly. Shannon reaches out and holds her hand.

SHANNON (V.O.)
Aunt jo was the kindest of all the servants in the house. In my past life, she always warned me about Ricky, but I was so blind in love that I pushed her away. In this life, I won’t fail her again.

AUNT JO
Sorry miss, I spoke out of turn...

SHANNON
It’s okay, Aunt jo. You were right. I'm going to go lay down for a bit. It's been a long day.

AUNT JO
Alright. Oh, Johnny Wonder came to visit. I can send him away though, if you're tired...

About to leave the room, hearing that, Shannon's face lights up in excitement.

SHANNON
Johnny? Where is he?

Aunt Jo points and Shannon runs that direction.

EPISODE 10

16 EXT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - TERRACE - NIGHT 16

Shannon steps out of the house and sees, standing in a pool of light, the most handsome young man in the world, JOHNNY WONDER. This is the first time she's seen him since being reborn.

He hears her gasp and turns. The entire world slows down as this beautiful person turns to rest his eyes on Shannon.

SHANNON (V.O.)
This is 20 year old Johnny, the fiancé my father arranged for me. In my past life, because of Ricky Trax, I was not fond of him. He wanted to be with me, but I wanted only Ricky. I not only refused him but also said hurtful things to him.

She holds back tears. Johnny isn't sure what's up but he only cares for her.

SHANNON
Johnny, it's so nice to see you again.

JOHNNY
Miss Clark, it’s nice to see you too.

SHANNON
Johnny, is there something you needed?

JOHNNY
I wanted to see you.

Hesitating, in awkward silence.

JOHNNY (cont'd)
I know you don’t want to see me, so I’ll go.

Johnny turns away, ready to leave, when Shannon stops him.

SHANNON
Johnny...

She almost grabs his hand to stop him from going.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Would you like to have dinner with me?

JOHNNY
Really?

The romantic tension between them is insane. We half-expect them to start making out right then and there.

SHANNON
Sure. Aunt Jo is the best chef!

As she leads Johnny inside she can't help looking over her shoulder and smiling at him.

EPISODE 11

17 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT 17

Aunt Jo bustles in the kitchen while Shannon and Johnny sit shyly near each other trying to steal looks at the other but not get caught doing it.

SHANNON
Aunt jo, let’s start dinner.

AUNT JO
We're not waiting for Ricky?

Hearing "Ricky", Johnny's eyes dart to Shannon, watching to see what she'll say.

SHANNON
Why?

AUNT JO (V.O.)
Thank goodness, Miss Shannon won't be such a suck-up anymore.

AUNT JO
I'll get everything ready right away.

SHANNON
Johnny, you're grades are really good, aren't they? Mine are terrible. Would you mind...being my tutor? You could come here every day and help me study.

JOHNNY
I thought Ricky Trax was your tutor?

JOHNNY (V.O.)
And you love him so much you pushed me far away from you.

SHANNON
He's about to be fired.

Johnny barely suppresses a smile.

JOHNNY
If you would like, I'm available. Maybe we could begin tomorrow?

SHANNON
Yes. Tomorrow, then.

Johnny leaves. Moments later Ricky storms in, angry.

RICKY
Shannon, why'd you tear my dad a new one in front of everyone? What's wrong with you? Go apologize to him right now or I'll--

SHANNON
I disciplined my driver. I pay his salary and he leaves me on the side of the road! And you think I should apologize?

RICKY
He's my dad! Anything he did was because I told him to do it!That's my dad! It had nothing to do with him. If you have an issue, deal with me!

SHANNON
Oh, right. Your father answers to you. In that case, you can both pack your bags and go.

RICKY
What? What did you just say?

He feels a thrill of fear. He knows he's playing with fire and in danger of getting burned.

Shannon is ready to set him on fire.

EPISODE 12

18 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT 18

Shannon slams her hand on the table. Rattling dishes. Her hand landing near the handle of a very sharp knife.

SHANNON
I don't want you here anymore! Ever since you started tutoring me, my grades have only gotten worse. Why am I paying you anything at all!

RICKY
It's not my fault your stupid! I explain the same thing to Karen, one time, the same way and she gets it. Why can't you? Because you're as dumb as a rock. Switch tutors, see if I care, but don't come crawling back when you fail even faster.

SHANNON
Fine! I will, but you and your good for nothing Dad can't live here anymore. I want you both out!

Ricky tries a different approach, full-condescension.

RICKY
OK, OK, it's you're not dumb, Shannon. You're obsessed with dating me so you can't focus. That's why your grades are so bad.

SHANNON
What are you talking about?

RICKY
You’re causing all this fuss because you’re jealous of my relationship with Karen, right?

SHANNON
You think I want to be with you?

RICKY
Oh my god, it's OBVIOUS!

SHANNON
Ricky Trax, being with you is the last thing I want in this life!

RICKY
Say whatever you want. But I am warning you—if you disrespect me like that in public again...whatever I do next is your fault.

EPISODE 13

19 INT. CAR - DAY 19

After school, Shannon gets in the car and shuts the door. After a moment of confusion she looks at the driver.

SHANNON
Let’s go.

Ricky walks over with Karen next to him.

RICKY
Dad’s let's drop off Karen first.

MR. TRAX
Alright, my boy.

SHANNON
Driver, did you even ask for my opinion? From now on, there will be no unnecessary people in my car. Including him.

Ricky shoves his way into the car, but Shannon refuses to make enough room for Karen, who stands there watching.

MR. TRAX
Miss Shannon, you have a good relationship with Ricky, right? Don't let something small hurt your feelings for him.

SHANNON
Mister Trax, I don’t think suited to driving. Someone who loves doling out advice should be a therapist. Was that your dream? Could you not cut it in med school? Is that why you're a driver?

RICKY
Shannon! That's enough! How can y ou talk to my fa--your driver like that?

SHANNON
How dare YOU speak to YOUR employer this way?

She literally kicks him out of the car.

SHANNON (cont'd)
You think you’re worthy to sit with me? (to Mr. Trax) DRIVE!

He drives. Leaving his own son on the side of the road.

RICKY
Shannon, you've really pissed me off this time! I'll see you on your knees begging for my forgiveness!

KAREN
Ricky, what’s going on with you? She's the daughter of your *driver*. Why are you letting her push you around like this?

KAREN (V.O.)
Everyone says she's the rich one and you're the fake...maybe they're right?

20 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 20

The next morning at school. Shannon is at her desk reading when Ricky comes up and leans over her.

RICKY
Shannon, I heard you were talking to Johnny Wonder.

SHANNON
What's it to you?

RICKY
Bringing him around, trying to make me jealous isn't going to make me forgive you, if that's what you think.

SHANNON
Why would I think that? I don't even like thinking about you.

RICKY
You know, I can’t stand women who can’t make up their minds. Am I making myself clear?

She glares up at him, narrowing her eyes.

SHANNON
Oh, I've made up my mind about you.

EPISODE 14

21 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 21

Shannon stands up, forcing Ricky to take a step back so she doesn't bash him with her head.

SHANNON
I can't believe I tolerated you for so long. You treat me this way and then spend MY money on...KAREN?

Ricky punches the table, trying to restrain his anger.

RICKY
Your money? I earned that money trying to fix your dumb brain! Compensation for heavy labor!

SHANNON
Maybe if I demand a refund my grades will go back up!

RICKY
I already told you it's not my fault! It's your mind that's the problem!

SHANNON
Ricky, you're fired!

RICKY
You think someone else--

SHANNON
I already hired a new tutor.

Ricky moves closer, keeping his voice lower, not sure if Shannon is playing the part he wants her to play.

RICKY
Shannon, if you're playing hard to get or something you need to cut it out. If you keep this up, I really won't be your tutor anymore and where do you think that leaves you?

SHANNON
Oh my god, and you call me dumb. Ricky, you are fiieee-rrrrrr-DUH!

Shannon walks out of the room.

RICKY
You--

Ricky is about to follow Shannon but Karen blocks his path.

KAREN
Ricky, what's really going on with you and Shannon?

RICKY
Who knows? Don’t gives a shit.

KAREN
Right. OK. Anyway, tomorrow is your birthday. Are we still celbrating at your family's hotel? Are you going to help me rent a dress? Ricky? Ricky!

RICKY
What? No. Why would you rent a dress? I'll buy you one.

Karen smiles slyly to herself. Free dress coming her way.

Ricky looks away, distracted by something he just realized.

RICKY (V.O.)
THAT'S what's going on. Shannon always plans my birthday celebrations. She's just acting dramatic to heighten the surprise. Ha, nice try Shannon but I told you you were going to far. You'll find my forgiveness costs more than a birthday party.

Ricky smiles to himself.

EPISODE 15

22 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 22

Ricky looks at Karen, smiling to himself. She doesn't understand why he's looking so smug.

KAREN
Ricky, why aren’t you saying anything?

Instead of answering, Ricky wraps his arm around Karen's waist and turns so they both face the rest of the class. Everyone listens intently.

RICKY
Listen up everyone, tomorrow night at the Royal Court Hotel, it’s my 20th birthday. There will be food, music, drink...a night to remember!

The class can't contain their excitement.

SUE
Oh my god! The Royal Court Hotel? That's like...higher than five stars! I can't believe he's celebrating there!

YANCEY
Of course he is, the Trax family OWNS the Royal Court. The staff literally BOW to Ricky.

Ricky and Karen watch Sue and Yancey praise them with a mixture of smugness and embarrassment.

SUE
Holy shit! Yancey, you HAVE to get me a ticket!

RICKY
What are you talking about, Sue? A ticket? I personally invited you! Every single one of you is personally invited!

While the crowd cheers...Karen speaks to Ricky.

KAREN
Ricky, do you think Shannon will come? Should we invite her?

RICKY
Her? Even if I don’t send her an invitation, she’ll come running.

RICKY (V.O.)
Shannon, you think you're so clever. You think this party will save you? Nope, you're in a for rude awakening. NOBODY disrespects me.

KAREN
Yeah, she can't stay away from you. I'll have to teach her a lesson.

Karen looks up lovingly at Ricky, with the faintest of smirks on her face.

EPISODE 16

23 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

At a elegant glass desk, Johnny and Shannon sit next to each other. Johnny diligently works through a complicated math problem, explaining the steps, but Shannon stares at him dreamily, absorbed in her own thoughts.

SHANNON (V.O.)
God, Johnny is nothing like Ricky. Johnny has patience, he speaks well, he never complains. And OH MY GOODNESS is he handsome. (beat) How could I have been so blind in my previous life?
(MORE)

SHANNON (V.O.) (CONT'D)
How could I waste all my time on someone like Ricky Trax. Especially when Johnny was right there all along!

She doesn't realize Johnny is watching her think.

JOHNNY
Is there something you don’t understand?

She doesn't say anything, just keeps looking at him. Then she realizes he said something and snaps out of it.

SHANNON
Sorry, I’m just too dumb.

JOHNNY
Shannon, you're not dumb. You're just using the wrong study method. Let me help you build a stronger foundation first, then if your grades don't improve...you can fire me and I'll return everything you've paid me already.

SHANNON
Are you sure? You really mean that?

Johnny nods. Then they smile at each other. Ricky stomps into the room. He doesn't even acknowledge Johnny and rips into Shannon.

RICKY
Shannon, seriously, what’s your deal?

She speaks slowly and clearly, like she's dealing with a child.

SHANNON
What do you want now?

RICKY
You threw my things in the basement!

Johnny carefully watches the back and forth.

SHANNON
I told you this afternoon, you've been fired. I have a new tutor. So why should you stay at my house? Especially in such a nice room? ESPECIALLY after I fired your father too! But if you insist on staying, the basement is all yours.

Ricky slams his palms on the desk. Shannon doesn't flinch.

RICKY
Shannon, do you think it's fun to humiliate me?

SHANNON
Humiliate you? Stop being so dramatic.

RICKY
Fine, Shannon, don’t think I don’t know what you’re up to.

RICKY (V.O.)
Tomorrow at the birthday party, I’ll make sure you regret this. I’ll make you kneel in front of everyone and apologize.

Shannon slaps the papers with each word, trying to break through Ricky's dense idiocy.

SHANNON
We’re still in class. Can you stop interrupting us?

Ricky is thrown off his game. He's still not used to Shannon resisting him.

RICKY
Fine. Just wait.

Ricky points a finger at Shannon. Johnny shifts his weight, ready to leap in and defend Shannon if necessary. Ricky and Shannon both notice.

EPISODE 17

24 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

As Ricky passes through the kitchen, he pauses and holds up three fingers.

RICKY
She'll be here in three, two, one...

He turns around, grinning smugly. She's not there.

RICKY (cont'd)
What the heck? Why is Shannon suddenly acting so tough? She knows she's making me angry. I swear she is going to learn a hard lesson.

25 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - STUDY - NIGHT 25

Shannon stamps her foot in frustration. Behind her, Johnny is packing up his papers, folders, and pencils.

SHANNON
I'm sorry you had to see that, Johnny.

She sits down next to Johnny.

JOHNNY
Maybe I should just go. You don't seem to be in a good mood.

SHANNON
No, I'm fine. Really, I'm in a good mood.

JOHNNY
That's good to hear.

Shannon puts her hands on Johnny's arm to keep him from leaving. Both a little embarrassed by the intimacy.

SHANNON
By the way, are you free tomorrow night? I want to go to the Royal Court Hotel for dinner. Do you want to join me? It's been so many years since I last ate there. I miss the food.

Johnny's mood darkens, saddens.

JOHNNY
Years? Didn't you just go there with Ricky last week? You...seem to take him there a lot.

SHANNON
How do you know that?

JOHNNY
Because the Royal Court Hotel is--

He looks her in the eye and hesitates. He was about to say "my family's hotel."

JOHNNY (cont'd)
I was there, too, and I saw you.

She becomes playful and teasing to pull him out of the mood.

SHANNON
So, do you want me to go back to avoiding you like before? Do you want me to be with him?

JOHNNY
Of course not.

SHANNON
Then, see you tomorrow.

They realize she's still holding onto his hand. They smile sheepishly and look away, and then look back at each other. Happy and exhilarated.

EPISODE 18

26 INT. ROYAL COURT HOTEL - LOBBY - NIGHT 26

The lobby is filled with classmates guests dressed in party attire when Shannon arrives. Every eye instantly turns to scrutinize her.

But she doesn't even look their way, until...

YANCEY
Shannon, how dare you show up here?

SHANNON
Yancey? What are you talking about?

YANCEY
After everything you have the nerve to come to Johnny's birthday party?

The other students start snickering at Shannon.

SHANNON
It’s his birthday today?

She thinks for second and gasps. Then laughs at herself.

SHANNON (cont'd)
I TOTALLY forgot! Ha!

SHANNON (V.O.)
Now I remember. Last time, I spent 100k on that asshole's birthday party. And when I was about to confess my feelings for him he shoved his tongue down Karen's throat. Well, this time, I’ll give Ricky Trax an unforgettable birthday.

Yancey cuts off Shannon's inner monologue.

YANCEY
Quit pretending. Ricky didn't invite you and you wanted to show up anyway. You're so...unclassy.

SHANNON
Who do you think you are anyway? Are you Ricky's little bitch or Karen's? I don’t even know your name, but I hear you yap-yap-yapping! God you're annoying.

Yancey wasn't expecting a brutal frontal assault and withers beneath Shannon's words.

Ricky, with Karen on his arm, strolls across the lobby to confront Shannon.

RICKY
I'm surprised you showed up, Shannon. Don't think thwoing this party will make me forgive you.

SHANNON
You're really something, Ricky. Thinking everything is about you.

RICKY
(confused)
You’re not here to celebrate my birthday?

SHANNON
Ew, no! Why would I celebrate your birthday? You think you deserve the honor?

RICKY
What’s that supposed to mean?

KAREN
Shannon, it's Ricky’s birthday, let's not cause trouble. His family has always treated you well, he's always treated you like a friend...not like a servant...so don't make him angry.

Karen reaches to place a gently hand on Shannon, but Shannon yanks away throwing Karen off balance. Karen steps on her own dress and stumbles like Shannon shoved her.

RICKY
Shannon, if you've got a problem, bring it up with me. Don't get violent with Karen or we're going to have a serious problem.

Ricky scowls darkly at Shannon. She is unafraid.

EPISODE 19

27 INT. ROYAL COURT HOTEL - LOBBY - NIGHT 27

Ricky gets into Shannon's face, jamming a finger an inch from the bridge of her nose.

RICKY
Now you will apologize to Karen right now.

STUDENTS
Apologize, apologize, apologize!

KAREN
Ricky, forget it. It’s your birthday today, I don’t want to make scene. Besides, I don't believe Shannon did it on purpose.

Ricky ignores Karen.

RICKY
Shannon, are you going to apologize or not?

SHANNON
I didn't push her. Why the f--hell should I apologize?

YANCEY
Shannon, how dare you talk back to Ricky like that! You're such a monster. You hate yourself so much you pick on Karen because she's sweet and kind and that makes her an easy target for someone like you!

Yancey pushes Shannon to the floor. She tries to kick Shannon's face, but Shannon dodges.

YANCEY (cont'd)
If Ricky won't beat you, I will!

Yancey punctuations each line with a kick at Shannon, which Shannon deftly dodges, much to Karen's frustration.

YANCEY (cont'd)
You’re Ricky's' god-damn maid! Someone needs to put you in your place.

Shannon pulls a muscle in her back dodging the blows and Yancey reaches down to twist Shannon's wrist backward. Hard.

JOHNNY (V.O.)
Stop!

Everyone looks, Johnny Wonder stands at the other end of the lobby, looking every inch like a young mob-boss. He's pissed and he stalks toward Yancey.

EPISODE 20

28 INT. ROYAL COURT HOTEL - LOBBY - NIGHT 28

Johnny stalks across the lobby. Shannon smiles, rubbing her sore wrist. Ricky takes a step toward Johnny, but Karen pulls him back, Johnny looks at Ricky dismissively.

JOHNNY
You must have a death wish!

Johnny kicks Yancey away from Shannon. Everyone gasps. Yancey yelps in pain but nobody moves to help her.

Johnny kneels down to lift Shannon to her feet. She leaps up quickly and their lips nearly meet, they hold each other, staring into each other's beautiful eyes...

SHANNON
Johnny! You saved me...again.

JOHNNY
What do you mean? Again?

Seeing their intimate embrace infuriates Ricky.

RICKY
Shannon, get over here right now!

Instead of dealing with Johnny, he yanks on Shannon's arm. Wrong move.

JOHNNY
Don’t touch her!

Johnny uses his open palm to shove Ricky away. Ricky stumbles back, pathetically off balance. He quickly recovers and smooths out his suit.

RICKY
You...really didn't come for my birthday? You came to meet HIM? I told you I don't like you being around him!

SHANNON
Ricky, get over yourself! When your lackey was trying to kill me you did nothing! But when someone helps me you get mad? What is wrong with your head!

RICKY
Oh calm down, Yancey couldn't even hit you could she? And besides, you hurt Karen first.

Karen, casually humiliated, scoffs and dies a little inside. Ricky saunters closer to Shannon and Johnny, lowering his voice as much as he can without sounding weak.

Karen is not impressed, she wants a strong tough man and Ricky is not playing the part.

RICKY (cont'd)
Enough, let's stop causing a scene and I won't blame you for tonight. Everyone is here for the birthday party YOU promised so don't embarrass yourself alright?

Shannon cocks an eyebrow: seriously?

EPISODE 21

29 INT. ROYAL COURT HOTEL - LOBBY - NIGHT 29

Shannon can't believe what she just heard Ricky say.

SHANNON
After all the shit you put me through, you just wanted me to throw you a birthday party?

RICKY
If being with Karen bothers you this much...I'll stay away from Karen, alright? Will that be enough for you to chill out?

Karen can't believe what she heard, but wants to stay close to her source of power and value.

Johnny is polite enough to not laugh in Ricky's face. So he keeps his face neutral, waiting and watching to make sure Shannon stays safe.

SHANNON (V.O.)
You're so pathetic. Can't let your "rich boy" image get tarnished in front of everyone. Fine. I'll play along and you'll see how it turns out.

She puts on a contrite, understanding face, and acts all demure and considerate of the "man" in front of her. Johnny is confused but says nothing.

SHANNON
I understand. I don't want to ruin everyone's fun. And your right, I reserved the Platinum Lounge. Will that be OK for your party?

Ricky smirks like a smug little prick.

RICKY (V.O.)
In the end, Shannon is still throwing me the party. She really is my obedient little bitch. And she will be forever.

RICKY
That will do fine. Thank you. (to everyone) Alright, LET'S PARTY!

After Ricky leads his followers away, Shannon looks at Johnny and smiles a devious little grin.

JOHNNY
Did you really reserve the Platinum Lounge?

She shakes her head.

SHANNON
No. No I did not. But it's Ricky-boy's birthday right? He should have some fun. Until he can't pay the bill. I heard the owner of this hotel is ruthless. What do you think will happen if he can’t pay? Maybe they’ll break his legs.

As she explains, Johnny's smile grows bigger and bigger. This is a fun plan.

JOHNNY
But actually, the owner of the Royal Court Hotel isn’t that bad-tempered.

SHANNON
Mmm, too bad. In that case I'll settle for Ricky kneeling down and begging me to save him.

Shannon takes his arm and walks toward the Hotel Restaurant.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Johnny, to thank you for saving me earlier. May I take you to dinner?

EPISODE 22

30 INT. HOTEL RESTAURANT - NIGHT 30

Shannon and Johnny enjoy an appetizer. From where they sit they can see the door to the Platinum Lounge. It's cracked open so light and music spill out.

MUCH LATER

Shannon and Johnny finish their dessert. The party is suddenly shut down. A very upset and humiliated looking Ricky comes out, looks around, spots Shannon and hurries over.

He doesn't say anything, waits for Shannon to speak first.

SHANNON
Ricky Trax, you look upset. Is something wrong?

RICKY
You know. You did this on purpose.

From the door to the Platinum Lounge, Karen, Yancey and Sue watch Ricky talking to Shannon.

SHANNON
I don’t need to expose you now. Your embarrassment is only just beginning.

She slips a credit car from her purse but doesn't hand it over quite yet.

31 INT. HOTEL RESTAURANT - NIGHT 31

Shannon arches an eyebrow at Ricky and his desperation.

A WAITER delivers the check to Johnny. Ricky can't help but notice Johnny taking out a credit card and handing it to the waiter.

Johnny smirks at Ricky.

SHANNON
Since Ricky Trax can’t bring himself to say ask nicely, I guess I’ll just have to tell everyone the truth.

He's on the verge of tears.

RICKY
Alright! Shannon. Alright. Please pay the bill.

Shannon isn't impressed by his attitude, but hands the card over regardless. Ricky walks back to the Platinum Lounge without a word to the girls watching

RICKY (V.O.)
I've never been humiliated like this before. Everyone is laughting at me. I'll make Shannon pay...pay double for this!

YANCEY
Why is Shannon paying for Ricky's party? Can he not afford it?

KAREN
Of course he can afford it. He left his credit card with his servant so she could eat...and look where she went.

YANCEY
The most expensive restaurant...and with him! She's so shameless.

Yancey don't see the concern and confusion on Karen's face.

EPISODE 23

32 INT. HOTEL RESTAURANT - NIGHT 32

Shannon and Johnny watch Ricky's party dissolve. Everyone shuffles out of the hotel. Karen looks over at Shannon, but Ricky studiously refuses to look.

Shannon smiles, and looks at Johnny.

SHANNON
I was supposed to treat you to dinner, but it looks like you got a show too! I hope you enjoyed yourself.

JOHNNY
You spent a lot on that dickhead. I'll have the manager refund you.

SHANNON
I didn't realize the hotel belonged to you. There's no need to repay me, don't waste your money on Ricky. But holy cow, the food here is amazing!

JOHNNY
If it suits you, come whenever you like. Treat it like it's your own place.

SHANNON
Are you suggesting I dine for free?

JOHNNY
Do you pay for food at home?

SHANNON
No...

They smile at each other.

SHANNON (V.O.)
In my past life, my father tried to arrange a marriage between Johnny and me. But I resisted, and refused to get to know him. What a terrible mistake...he's wonderful.

JOHNNY
It's late, may I drive you home?

SHANNON
Yes, of course.

Johnny stands, offering Shannon his hand. She takes it and they head out.

33 EXT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - DRIVEWAY - NIGHT 33

Johnny opens the car door for Shannon and helps her out. The perfect gentleman. As she heads to the door she keeps looking over her shoulder, smiles and waves.

34 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT 34

As soon as she opens the door, Mr. Trax is there, hands clasped like a praying beggar.

MR. TRAX
Miss Clark, you’re finally back. I brought Ricky to apologize to you.

She ignores them both and walks away.

EPISODE 24

35 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - STUDY - NIGHT 35

Shannon picks up a magazine and tries to read but Mr. Trax isn't leaving. When she speaks she doesn't make eye contact.

SHANNON
Mr. Trax, your son didn’t offend me, so he doesn’t need to apologize.

MR. TRAX
But...you fired him.

SHANNON
Yes, I did, I also fired you, Mr. Trax. One is a tutor who makes my grades worse and the other is a driver who left me on the side of the road. And they still have the nerve to live on my property...can you imagine?

Mr. Trax kneels down in front of her.

MR. TRAX
Miss Clar, Shannon, please...it was my fault. I need this job. Please. Your father is my classmate. I can't let him down.

SHANNON
Maybe you should have thought of that before abandoning me on the SIDE OF THE ROAD!

MR. TRAX
I--I'll talk to Ricky! I'll make sure he teaches you better.

SHANNON
Mr. Trax, you keep talking about how your son but he isn't saying anything. He isn't apologizing. He's' sitting there moping.

MR. TRAX
Get up and apologize to Shannon.

He yanks Ricky to his feet. But Ricky stays silent. Mr. Trax leans close to Ricky and hisses at him.

MR. TRAX (cont'd)
You don't really want her to fire both of us, do you? I owe a lot of money and I need this job to pay it off or it's coming out of your tuition.

Mr. Trax grabs his son's collar in his fist and twists.

MR. TRAX (cont'd)
Get on her good side, the entire Clark family fortune could be yours in the future.

Ricky's face turns red.

EPISODE 25

36 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - STUDY - NIGHT 36

While Mr. Trax chastises at Ricky, Shannon scrolls through TikTok, volume up and laughs too loudly on purpose.

MR. TRAX
Did you hear me clearly? Get your shit together and apologize.

SHANNON
YAWN! It’s getting late, and I’m tired. I should go to bed.

Mr. Trax slaps Ricky across the face.

MR. TRAX
(screaming)
I told you to apologize to Miss Clark. NOW!

RICKY
Shannon, this time you’ve really gone too far.

Ricky walks out.

Mr. Trax shakes his fists in frustration. Half-smiles at Shannon and hurries after his son.

SHANNON
Ricky Trax, in our past life, I didn’t just support you, I supported your gambling addict father too. In this life, I’d like to see you pay off his debts without the Clark family’s protection.

37 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 37

Shannon madly erases something from her homework. Yancey approaches cautiously.

YANCEY
Shannon, did you really pay for Ricky's birthday party?

Shannon nods.

YANCEY (cont'd)
We always thought Ricky was the rich one...does this mean--

SHANNON
If you want to know more, just ask your master himself. I'm sure he'll tell you everything.

She smirks at Yancey and returns to her homework.

EPISODE 26

38 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 38

Shannon is exhausted by this but the girls won't leave her alone.

SUE
We just find it really strange—if you spend so much money on Ricky, why isn't he with you? Why is he with Karen?

Ricky saunters into the classroom. Yancey, as usual, follows a few paces behind her master.

RICKY
Because no matter how much of my own money Shannon throws back at me it'll never change her poor grades, her two-timing heart, and soul full of lies. She can't even compare to one of Karen's fingers.

YANCEY
That’s right! She’s at the bottom of the class in grades. She throws money at Ricky trying to impress him but goes to dinner with some other guy? Even IF she's a rich girl, she's a bad person.

SUE
Exactly! The worst! Bad brain, bad heart. No wonder Ricky doesn’t like her.

RICKY
Yesterday’s party? She insisted on throwing a huge event and then begged to borrow my credit card! She did it all to make a scene. To humiliate me and embarrass all of you. And before she says it's her money, it's the money I was owed for all the time I wasted TRYING to teach Shannon Rock-Brain Clark! Her money isn't worth anything at all!

Shannon starts laughing.

RICKY (cont'd)
What are you laughing at?

She laughs harder.

EPISODE 27

39 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 39

Shannon forces herself to stop laughing and gets angry.

SHANNON
You're the worst tutor in the world. It's incredible you do well in class at all.

RICKY
I'm great. My grades are great so it's your fault yours are bad.

SHANNON
Are you sure it’s because I’m dumb and not because of the way you teach?

RICKY
Whatever man, didn't you get a new tutor? Let's see how well you do. I bet you'll do worse than before!

SHANNON
Wanna bet?

RICKY
Sure. The rankings are public. If you move up 100 spots, which is not all that much, I'll admit it was my fault.

He gloats over his brilliant move.

SHANNON
Deal.

RICKY
Great! I'm so confident I'm not the problem I'll punish myself by running ten miles around the school track. If she wins.

Shannon rolls her eyes, scoffs at his "punishment".

SHANNON
What does that have to do with me? Ricky, if I win, you will kneel down and beg me to forgive you!

Ricky's bluster falters, and Shannon smiles at his discomfort.

EPISODE 28

40 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 40

Everyone watching gasps when Shannon makes her offer.

SUE
Are you insane? You think it's OK to even ASK that of Ricky?

YANCEY
Sure, he'll do that if you promise to do the exact same thing. But you bow down every day for a WEEK! Unless you're scared and want to back out.

Shannon gives her the A-ok sign and walks awawy.

SUE
Insane! She actually agreed?

RICKY
She must be out of her mind!

41 EXT. SCHOOL - DAY 41

Shannon exits to see a well dressed man standing next to a luxury car. They smile when they see each other.

Shannon runs to him and flings her arms around him.

SHANNON
Dad, when did you get back?

MR. CLARK
Ahhh, I missed you, so I came back. C'mon, get in the car. Let’s go home.

Yancey snaps photos of Shannon holding this "older man".

YANCEY
Oh my god, could that old man be Shannon’s new target? Ricky, is that guy you said she's hanging out with?

Ricky looks at the phone. Shares a meaningful look with Karen. The grin.

RICKY
That old guy...yeah, she wants him.

EPISODE 29

42 EXT. SCHOOL - DAY 42

Karen, Yancey, Sue, and Ricky loudly gossip about Shannon.

KAREN
Why is she all over a guy in his forties?

YANCEY
I knew she couldn't be rich. Shannon got herself a sugar daddy.

SUE
Ew. No wonder Ricky hates her. She's disgusting.

RICKY (V.O.)
Shannon, I know that's your father, but if you think I'll tell anyone? Not a chance! Enjoy your sugar daddy.

KAREN
Ricky, do you think her money comes from that old fart?

RICKY
Do you really think she’s that lucky otherwise?

KAREN
She’s relying on someone else—whether it’s you or her sugar daddy.

RICKY (V.O.)
Shannon, this is only the beginning.

43 INT. CAR - DAY 43

Mr. Clark can't help smiling when he sees how happy Shannon is to see him, but he's a little suspicious.

MR. CLARK
What’s going on? You’re never this warm when I come home. What happened?

SHANNON
Nothing. I just haven’t seen you in a long time, and I missed you, Dad.

SHANNON (V.O.)
In my past life, Dad was killed in an accident on a business trip. The whole Clark corporation was thrown into chaos. Somehow...becasue I was a fool...Ricky Trax and his good for nothing father TOOK THE COMPANY from me. In this life, I’m not only going to protect Clark Corporation, but I’m going to protect my father as well.

EPISODE 30

44 INT. CAR - DAY 44

Mr. Clark takes Shannon's hand and makes sure she's listening.

MR. CLARK
Shannon, is that Ricky Trax boy giving you trouble again? Listen to me, he's not worth hanging around. I want to introduce you to one of my friend's sons, Johnny Wonder.

Shannon smiles.

MR. CLARK (cont'd)
Ridiculous name. I know, but he's a great guy. Not only is his family the richest in the game, he's a really good guy. Would you give him a chance? For me?

SHANNON
For you? Anything.

She smiles and hugs him again.

MR. CLARK (V.O.)
Did hell freeze over? Whenever I criticize Ricky she loses her mind.

MR. CLARK
Shannon, are you sure you’re okay?

SHANNON
Dad, I think you'll be happy to know I've fired Ricky Trax and his father. But if you want me to meet Johnny Wonder you have to promise me something.

MR. CLARK
What is it?

SHANNON
No more business trips this year. Stay home.

MR. CLARK
Alright, I think I can do that. I'm meeting with the Wonder family this evening. Would you like to come with me?

SHANNON
No thank you, my new tutor Johnny Wonder is coming by tonight.

Mr. Clark can't contain his surprise.

MR. CLARK
Alright, alright! Let's go. You devious child.

45 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - STUDY - DAY 45

Shannon is sitting next to Johnny while he goes over her homework. But she looks nervous. She opens her mouth once or twice before she's able to speak.

SHANNON
There’s something I need to tell you. I made a bet with Ricky. If I don't move up 100 places on the next exam...I'll have to kneel down and beg his forgiveness...

JOHNNY
And if you win?

SHANNON
He has to run ten miles and bow down and beg for my forgiveness...

Johnny looks concerned like he may think she's gong to lose. Shannon panics inside.

EPISODE 31

46 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - STUDY - DAY 46

Johnny turns to face Shannon, makes sure he has eye contact and her full attention. Then he smiles.

JOHNNY
I’ll make sure you win.

SHANNON
Really?

JOHNNY
You've working hard and you're improving.

SHANNON
Are you sure? I know I'm better...but 100 places higher?

JOHNNY
Don't worry about it we have time. Plus, if I'm being honest, Ricky was an awful tutor. He's why you're so behind.

SHANNON
I knew it! What an a-hole. Alright! Master, I'm in your hands, train me well!

They shake hands.

47 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 47

The teacher walks into the room holding a stack of papers. All the students immediately sit down, hushed in anticipation.

TEACHER
Class, the results of the monthly exam are out. As expected, Ricky and Karen topped the class again.

YANCEY
I guess Shannon will be running all afternoon.

TEACHER
However, I also need to call attention to someone else—Shannon Cark.

The class goes dead silent. Yancey is the first to recover her pettiness.

YANCEY
Teacher, did Shannon go from dead last to...second to last?

The class erupts in laughter.

EPISODE 32

48 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 48

Teacher smacks her desk to silence everyone in the room.

TEACHER
Yancey, who gave your mouth permission to spout idiocy? Shannon moved up 253 places. That's huge.

Shannon can't believe it. Nobody can, but for Shannon it's happy news. For Yancey...it's disaster.

YANCEY
What? Top 200? Teacher, did you make a mistake? Her grades were so poor before, how could she—

TEACHER
I didn't make any mistake. Shannon, keep it up the good work. I'm impressed.

Teacher graces Shannon with a well deserved smile.

SHANNON
Thank you, Teacher.

While Shannon isn't looking, Ricky gets up and tries to slip out of the room unnoticed.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Why are you in such a hurry, Lord Trax? Did you forget our bet?

RICKY
You got lucky this time.

SHANNON
So? Luck or not, you lost the bet. You need to start running and then you need to kneel down and beg. Or would you like to beg first?

YANCEY
Shannon, quit acting all high and mighty. So what if you improved 200 place? It’s not that impressive. Ricky is ranked first, and Karen is second. You don’t see them making a big deal about it.

SHANNON
What are you yapping about? Ricky bet I couldn't move up 100 places. I moved up 200. I won. He lost. Time to pay up. Lord Trax, Class Prince, Karen's pet, Dream of Yancey's heart you’re not going to go back on your word...are you?

He grits his teeth. Shannon has him trapped and everyone is watching the walls close in on him.

EPISODE 33

49 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 49

Ricky looks around the room. Everyone is watching him to see if he keeps his word.

RICKY
Fine, I’ll run but if you think I’ll kneel and apologize, forget it.

SHANNON
So you're going back on your word. Got it!

KAREN
Shannon, we're all friends. Asking Ricky to kneel and apologize is a bit much, don’t you think?

SHANNON
Who asked you to talk? You didn't make a peep about it being "a bit much" when your human-poodle Yancey wanted me to kneel every day for a week. You know what, you may kneel in Ricky's place.

Shannon snaps her fingers and points at the floor. Karen stamps her foot, wipes a fake tear from under her eye.

RICKY
Shannon, cut it out. You're going to far.

YANCEY
Shannon, don’t push your luck! Now, I’m starting to think you cheated in the exam just to make Ricky lose. Otherwise, how could your grades have improved so suddenly when he tutored you every day and you were still failing?

SHANNON
Do you have proof, bitch-breath?

YANCEY
Your past scores are proof enough! Besides, when would YOU have time to study...after seeing to your sugar daddy's "needs."

Shannon stands and backhands Yancey hard, red welts appear on her cheek. Shannon wears rings on that hand.

SHANNON
The fuck did you just say?

YANCEY
Just wait, Shannon, just wait. Every one will know you're a cheater and a whor--

WHAM! Shannon slaps her again. Yancey scurries out, humiliated and in tears. Shannon turns around and faces Ricky once more. He can't meet her eyes.

EPISODE 34

50 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 50

Teacher walks in the room, trailed by Yancey, and stops right in front of Shannon's desk. Teacher is furious.

TEACHER
Shannon, stand up.

Shannon stands up. Behind her, Yancey smiles in her seat.

SHANNON
Teacher, is there something wrong?

TEACHER
Someone has reported that you cheated in this exam. Do you have anything to say?

SHANNON
Teacher, does the "person" who reported me have any evidence?

TEACHER
Your grades have made a conspicuous leap. It's understandable that other students are suspicious.

SHANNON
Let them suspect me. I don’t care. I didn't cheat.

That creates shocked chatter around the room.

TEACHER
To protect your reputation, and a sense of fairness, I've decided to give you a new test. Would you agree to take it again?

SHANNON
No, of course not!

Yancey leaps to her feet, thinking it's over.

YANCEY
See! If you didn't cheat what would she be afraid of.?

SHANNON
If someone makes an accusation they should have proof. Otherwise, it's slander. What if they report me again tomorrow? And the day after? How many times will I have to redo work just to shut them up? I may as well drop out if I'm performing for them!

Yancey, still having slap marks on her face has no answer. But Ricky is stunned...

RICKY (V.O.)
When did she get so smart?

This is a very worrying thought for Ricky Trax.

EPISODE 35

51 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 51

Yancey scrambles for something to say. She points at Shannon. But Shannon keeps her eyes on the one who has the power: Teacher.

YANCEY
You! You're being unreasonable! The teacher already said you need to retake the exam, so stop arguing.

TEACHER
This retake is meant to clear your name. You don’t want people doubting you behind your back, do you?

SHANNON
Teacher, I find the reasoning behind this absurd. But for you, I will retake the exam.

KAREN
Shannon, it's no big deal. You don’t need to feel guilty.

SHANNON
Who says I feel guilty?

YANCEY
Hmph, still making excuses. Stubborn as always.

SHANNON
Yancey, shut up, you'll always find something to bitch about because you're so horny for Karen's approval. Teacher, since she accused me without any evidence, shouldn’t there be consequences?

YANCEY
What did you just say?

Oh damn, Yancey doesn't like being the one in the line of fire. She can't hide behind Ricky Trax anymore.

SHANNON
Teacher, Yancey accused me of cheating with no proof and has targeted me repeatedly. If I retake the exam and prove that I didn’t cheat, how about she drops out of school?

STUDENTS
You want her to drop out? Make her drop out! How can she be like this?

Shannon keeps her focus on Teacher while the class erupts in shocked protest.

EPISODE 36

52 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 52

Teacher puts a hand to her chest in surprise. Eyes dart around the room, she realizes she's losing control.

TEACHER
You want her to drop out?

SHANNON
She spread baseless rumors about me cheating. Even when I prove my innocence I'll always be the girl who was accused of cheating. Won't that damage my reputation? What if I can't handle the pressure and do something drastic...like...kill myself?

STUDENTS
Suicide? W-What should we do then? Maybe we should just let it go. Don’t say such things.

TEACHER
Alright, alright, Shannon you made your point..

Teacher knows she's being overly dramatic.

SHANNON
Yancey, didn't you insist that I cheated? Are you afraid of your own words?

YANCEY
I... I’m not afraid!

But maybe she has her doubts...she can't handle her own doubts show she doubles down.

YANCEY (cont'd)
Fine! But if I'm right YOU have to drop out. I don't want to be in the same class as someone--

SHANNON
Alright. Deal. Teacher, may I begin the exam?

Teacher nods, reaches for a new test. Shannon turns her withering gaze on Ricky.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Teacher, will you make sure Ricky keeps his word as well?

Ricky rises to his feet, calm where Yancey was uncertain, and tries to turn the tables on Shannon.

RICKY
Shannon, are you sure you want to do this? When they catch you, they'll kick you out of school. Just confess and I'll help you plead your case to the school board. OK?

With a lot of false concern and simpering fear.

SHANNON
What about our bet?

RICKY
I won't make you run.

SHANNON
Oh, thank you Ricky.

RICKY
But you will need to kneel down and beg for my forgiveness.

Shannon puts an L to her forehead.

SHANNON
Whatever Ricky, when I pass the test it'll be your dignity on the line. Better stretch those knees. You'll need them for running and for kneeling.

Shannon and Ricky stare each other down.

EPISODE 37

53 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 53

Shannon takes the exam. Everyone in the class watches and chats among themselves.

Then Shannon closes her pen and hands the test to Teacher. Teacher looks over the exam and her eyes go wide.

YANCEY
Teacher, are you stalling because you know she cheater? I know she did.

KAREN
Teacher, if she did so poorly, maybe we should let it end now and cancel the bet. I think Yancey won't force her to drop out...if Shannon apologizes to her.

YANCEY
Karen, you're so kind, don't you remember how brutally she insulted you? She deserves to be kicked out of school.

RICKY
She's right, Karen. She should run ten miles and then kneel before me. She needs to be taught a lesson.

KAREN
Shannon, how about you just apologize to Ricky and Yancey? We can pretend none of this ever happened, okay?

SHANNON
Why are you people talking? Has the teacher said anything? Do you know anything? Who are you performing for? At least show her some respect before you mouth off.

Everyone watches Teacher as she grades the test. Finally, she flips it over and puts her pen down. She takes a few calming breaths.

All the students are restless with anticipation.

TEACHER
Class, I want you to know the difficulty of this test was significantly higher than the one the entire class took earlier today.

YANCEY
Teacher, stop defending her. If she failed she failed.

RICKY
Exactly! if she wasn't a cheater she would have done fine on both tests.

Ricky puts his hands behind his head, smug in victory.

EPISODE 38

54 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 54

Karen leans her elbows on Shannon's desk, getting in her space and speaks with a mocking tone.

KAREN
Shannon, this is your last chance to come clean.

SHANNON
Karen, this is your last warning. Back up or don't complain when your face hurts more than Yancey's.

Teacher clears her throat to get the classes attention and stands.

TEACHER
As I said, this test was far more difficult than the previous exam and I'm happy to say Shannon scored higher than before. It's clear she did not cheat.

Silence. Then waves of dread ripple through the crowd.

YANCEY
How is that possible? How could she not have cheated?

KAREN
Teacher, you must have miscalculated the score.

TEACHER
ENOUGH!

The class goes silent.

TEACHER (cont'd)
Shannon, you've made incredible progress. I'm very impressed. I want to know what you've been doing to make such progress.

SHANNON
It's quite simple. I had a bad tutor. Now I have a good tutor.

She beams at the teacher.

SHANNON (cont'd)
It feels so GOOD doing well!

Teacher beams right back. Then she glares at the class.

TEACHER
This incident reveals how toxic the class environment is right now. I will do everything in my power to make sure Shannon's name stays clear and I'll make sure those who falsely accused Shannon cannot continue to do so and will face the appropriate consequences.

Shannon looks at Yancey. Yancey can't meet her eyes...

SHANNON
Yancey, you said if I didn't cheat, you would...drop out? Are you ready to keep your word?

Yancey stammers...and stammers...Shannon smiles.

EPISODE 39

55 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 55

Shannon paces in front of the other students like she's a teacher giving a lecture.

SHANNON
If you don't drop out I'll sue you for slander and spreading false rumors. And if that's not enough, the our teacher will know you are a dishonest, untrustworthy LIAR! Imagine the recommendation letters she's write about you...

Sue squats down and pets Yancey's arm, trying to calm her down. Tears are welling up.

KAREN
Shannon, we're all friends, she was worried you were going down the wrong path...morally. She wanted to wake you up! Don't ruin her future.

SUE
Right Isn't forcing her to drop out too much

SHANNON
If you're so concerned about Yancey, Karen, you can drop out in her place. Ricky will provide for you.

RICKY
Shannon, keep Karen out of this.

SUE
Yeah, Karen defended you. She treats everyone equally.

SHANNON
(deeply mocking)
Treats everyone equally? Where was she when you wanted me to drop out!

Karen's mouth twitches

KAREN
Of course...I would defend you. Dropping out is too far, Yancey!

SHANNON
Oh shut up Karen. You always act like a saint. I haven't forgotten and you'll get what's coming.

Shannon looks back to Yancey.

SHANNON (cont'd)
As for you, Yancey, if you really, really don't want to drop out we could come to an arrangement.

Yancey can't hide the desperation. Whatever Shannon wants: she'll do it.

YANCEY
Please...

EPISODE 40

56 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 56

Yancey straightens up in her seat, desperate for anything to save herself.

YANCEY
Please, whatever it takes...

SHANNON
Since you are someone who makes false accusations, but you really don't want to drop out, you can run twenty miles around the track...and while you're running you need to shout, as loud as you can, "I falsely accused Shannon. Shannon didn't cheat!" OK? Good!

Yancey's heart sinks but she's swallowing her pride. Ricky can't stand Shannon's new found power. He almost snaps his pen in aggravation.

RICKY
Shannon, it was one exam. She made a mistake there's no need to be so spiteful.

SHANNON
Ricky Trax thinks it's time to lecture me? How about you get on your knees and beg me to forgive you?

Shannon leaps to her feet and kicks Ricky behind the knee. Ricky kneels in pain.

KAREN
Ricky!

RICKY
Shannon, did you seriously just kick me?

SHANNON
You said you'd kneel. I'm helping you kneel. Now beg!

TEACHER
Shannon! Perhaps you shouldn't destroy your friendships over a test?

SHANNON
Teacher, these people are not my friends. If they don't keep their word I will never let this go and I will drive them out of school!

RICKY
Fine! It's ten miles. I'll run.

Shannon looks at Yancey.

YANCEY
I'll run ten also.

Shannon lifts an eyebrow.

YANCEY (cont'd)
Twenty...

Shannon enjoys her triumph. Even Teacher looks satisfied.

EPISODE 41

57 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 57

Karen stands up and stamps her foot. She looks angry and pouty at the same time.

KAREN
Shannon, are you trying to kill her? She can't run twenty miles!

SHANNON
She agreed to the bet. She should honor it. Unless...you're willing to run for her?

Yancey looks up, desperate for any assistance.

SHANNON (cont'd)
You don't need to run the full twenty. You can each run ten. How about that? Everyone knows you're so kind and willing to help anyone who needs it. Right?

Maybe Karen will be kind? She coughs pitifully.

KAREN
I...I have a weak constitution, I can't run...

Nope!

SHANNON
Well, Yancey, I was willing to help you but KAREN was unwilling.

She dramatically mocks Karen and swoons into her seat.

KAREN
You...

Karen scowls, she's exploding inside but she keeps a cool mask on her face.

KAREN (V.O.)
Shannon, just you wait!

Shannon stamps her foot. Everyone in the room flinches. She looks at Ricky and Yancey.

SHANNON
Why are you doing? RUN!

Ricky and Yancey scurry out of the room. Shannon hot on their heels.

58 EXT. TRACK - DAY 58

Ricky and Yancey are running. Exhausted. They didn't even change into proper attire.

Yancey stumbles and collapses onto the track.

59 INT. HOSPITAL - NIGHT 59

Yancey is in a hospital bed hooked up to IVs and monitors. Her eyelids flutter open and she tries to figure out where she is.

KAREN
Oh, you're awake. Thank god!

YANCEY
I hurt everywhere.

Shannon, listening outside, enters the room and lays into Yancey.

SHANNON
Get over yourself. A team of specialists examined every inch, nook, and cranny of your body. You're fine. The doctor specifically said you need to exercise more, OK?

Yancey nods weakly.

SHANNON (cont'd)
So you'll need to finish the last 12 miles as soon as possible.

Shannon turns to go. Yancey forces herself to sit up.

YANCEY
I don’t want to run anymore. If I keep running, I'll die!

Shannon waits in the doorway while Yancey despairs.

EPISODE 42

60 INT. HOSPITAL - NIGHT 60

Shannon comes back and flips through Yancey's chart.

SHANNON
Oh, dummy, you won't die. The entire hospital is watching out for you. But...if you really, truly, can't run just one more step...you can drop out of school. OK?

YANCEY
Why are you so mean?

SHANNON
Mean? Do you remember everything you said to me? And did to me...TODAY? So What's it going to be Yancey? Run or drop out?

YANCEY
Run...

SHANNON
Great! Good luck!

Shannon gives a thumbs up and heads out.

YANCEY
Karen, she's too powerful. I can't beat her.

KAREN
Don't worry, Yancey, she's being unreasoanble. Can you imagine how disgusting she must feel all the time having to please her Sugar Daddy? No wonder she's rude! Can you imagine what would happen if everyone found out? I dunno...maye it would set her on the right path.

Yancey has no idea Karen is planting thoughts in her head, manipulating her into doing her dirty work.

YANCEY
Karen, you're too kind. She's so cruel to you and you just want to see her be a better person. She's a disgrace to our school and she deserves to rot in hell. OH MY GOODNESS! I have pictures of her with that gross old man! I could post them online!

KAREN
(pretending to warn against doing this)
No, Yancey, that's too much. If the principal saw that...especially with the Outstanding Student Award Ceremony coming up...

YANCEY
I should do it AT THE CEREMONY!

Karen smiles deviously. Appreciating her weak-minded little lapdog.

EPISODE 43

61 INT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - STUDY - NIGHT 61

Shannon and Johnny sit at the table, both laughing. Shannon tries to catch her breath.

SHANNON
Let me tell you, Yancey fainted after eight miles! Ricky just kept running but he looked like he was going to die! I had her taken to the hospital just to freak her out even more. And she still promised to run the last twelve miles! I haven't felt this good in a long time.

She realizes Johnny isn't laughing anymore. He's just watching Shannon, enjoying seeing her so happy.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Do you think I was being too cruel?

JOHNNY
Of course not! If it were me, I probably would have been much worse.

SHANNON
Honestly, it's all because you've been tutoring me. I couldn't have done it without you.

They smile and look into each other's eyes.

SHANNON (cont'd)
By the way, the day after tomorrow our school's boxing team is having a match against your school's boxing team. Are you going to participate? Ricky always wins and I'd love to see someone kick his ass.

Johnny sees where this is going. She's trying to "persuade" him into doing something.

JOHNNY
Do you want me to participate?

She shouts in delight.

SHANNON
Of course, I do!

JOHNNY
Alright, I'll participate.

They both smile, they look deep into the other's eyes and lean forward, lips moving towards lips as we...fade out...

62 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 62

A boxing gym. The space for spectators is filling up. They all have foam hands, and noise makers. Shannon sits near the ring, alone. But everyone notices her.

BETTY
Isn't she Shannon?

SUE
Yeah, that's her. She looks decent, but I heard she has a forty year old sugar daddy AND she's trying to humiliate Ricky Trax.

BETTY
So vicious. A tumor like her should be kicked out of school.

Shannon whips around-stares them down. The girls shut up. Karen and Ricky come sit down near Shannon.

KAREN
Shannon, you're here! Did you come to cheer for Ricky?

SHANNON
I have zeeero interest in cheering for him.

Everyone gasps. Shannon has no interested and keeps watching for someone else to walk make his appearance.

EPISODE 44

63 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 63

Shannon picks imaginary lint from her clothes and flicks it away dismissively while she answers.

SHANNON
I'd rather choke on a boxing glove than cheer for Ricky.

Ricky scoffs like he doesn't care. But he slouches, a little deflated by the insult.

RICKY
You're such a bad liar. You always come cheer for me.

SHANNON
I'm most definitely not here for you. I'm over you. You're nothing to me.

RICKY
Just because your test scores went up doesn't make you special, or better than me and Karen.

SHANNON
Hmm? I didn't realize you're still talking. I wasn't listening.

KAREN
Enough, Shannon, we were trying to be polite. We were all friends once.

SHANNON
That god I developed some standards.

RICKY
Don’t bother with her, Karen. Who wants to be her friend anyway?

YANCEY
Shannon, you’re getting too full of yourself. Isn’t it just because you have a rich sugar daddy supporting you?

SHANNON
What did you just say? A what?

RICKY TRAX
Alright, ladies, and Shannon, it's time for me to shine!

SUE
Who are you playing?

RICKY
Some boy from some rundown school. He's got nothing on me.

Ricky runs out.

KAREN
Ricky, you’re amazing! Shannon, who do you think will win today?

SUE
Oh my god, is that the guy fighting Ricky?

Johnny Wonder strides toward the ring. The crowd erupts in cheers. He waves, but then sees Shannon and then truly smiles.

EPISODE 45

64 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 64

Yancey sees Johnny step into the ring. She's so surprised she spills her popcorn.

SUE
Isn't that Shannon's new boy toy?

YANCEY
She is really something. She has a sugar daddy, a boy toy, and she still thinks Ricky is going to date her?

SUE
He is quite handsome though.

YANCEY
He is really handsome. He's got a presence about him too. Hot damn, he might be better looking than Ricky...

She notices Karen staring at Johnny.

YANCEY (cont'd)
Right Karen?

Shannon blows kisses, makes hearts with her fingers, and generally acts all cute and in love. Ricky watches her with a "w...t...f?" expression all over his face.

KAREN (V.O.)
Everyone around Shannon is rich, outstanding or exceptional...well, I took Ricky from you. I'll take this guy too.

KAREN
I bet Shannon is trying to seduce this guy. I wonder if he knows about her sugar daddy?

YANCEY
I "hope" he "doesn't" find out. Who would want to date her after that?

KAREN
Once he finds out...

YANCEY
...he'll kick to the curb like Ricky did. Don't worry, Karen. He'll see the real Shannon soon.

Ricky "casually" walks closer to Shannon.

RICKY
You're not here to watch him, are you?

SHANNON
None of your business. Get lost!

KAREN (V.O.)
Shannon, laugh while you can. You won't be laughing for long.

Karen scowls at Shannon, but Shannon doesn't even notice. She's too busy looking at her Johnny Wonder.

EPISODE 46

65 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 65

Ricky walks into the ring in slow-motion like a badass. Even though he is not.

CROWD
Rick-y-Trax! Rick-y-Trax!
Rick-y-Trax! Rick-y-Trax!
Rick-y-Trax! Rick-y-Trax!

The boys size each other up. Ricky arrogant and cock. Johnny cool and collected.

They begin their bout. In an instant Shannon runs from "Ricky's Side" to "Johnny's Side" and holds up a sign cheering for: The Boy Wonder!

Karen and Yancey look offended by the betrayal.

It doesn't take long for Johnny to put Ricky on the defensive. And once Ricky is off balance...Johnny is ruthless.

When the whistle blows and Johnny is declared victorious, Ricky won't even shake his hand. He leaves Johnny hanging.

BETH
Ricky lost so badly. I thought he and Johnny were on the same level, but that was humiliating.

SUE
Ricky is a side character compared to Johnny.

BETH
Even Shannon has moved on. Remember how obsessed she was with Ricky? Absolutely shameless.

YANCEY
Good thing Johnny won't show her the time of day.

BETH
You sure about that?

YANCEY
How could he? She has a sugar daddy. The THOUGHT of it is revolting.

SHANNON
What did you say about me!

Before Shannon can beat the life of out Yancey. Johhny walks over and coughs to get Shannon's attention.

JOHNNY
Could you get me a bottle of water?

SHANNON
You were amazing today.

JOHNNY
Thanks, but I think I might have twisted my wrist earlier.

She checks his wrist.

JOHNNY (cont'd)
Could you hold the bottle for me?

She looks up at him, his face inches from her. Like asking her to help him drink water was the hottest thing in the world.

EPISODE 47

66 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 66

Shannon looks at Johnny, unsure if she heard him. He smiles at her confusion and repeats himself.

JOHNNY
Could you hold the bottle for me?

She smiles. Delighted to help.

SHANNON
Yes...of course.

She helps him drink water from the bottle...as she does, Yancey walks over.

YANCEY
You're...Johnny, right? I hope your not thinking about dating Shannon. She already has a sugar daddy.

JOHNNY
Shut up, you pathetic little cretin.

KAREN
Johnny, please don't be mad, Yancey is worried that you're being deceived. We're all friends with Shannon and we're concerned she's headed down the wrong path. She won't listen to us, but maybe you can talk to her?

JOHNNY
Your idea of helping a friend is spreading rumors about her? You sound like bad friends.

KAREN
That's not it. We genuinely want to help Shannon. Since she's chasing after you...we thought she might listen.

JOHNNY
Wait, you think Shannon is pursuing me?

KAREN
Isn't it obvious? She was like this with Ricky too.

JOHNNY
I see. Thank you for telling me, but, you're wrong about one thing.

He looks Shannon in the eye.

JOHNNY (cont'd)
I am pursuing her.

Shannon beams, poor Karen can't believe what she just heard.

KAREN
What?

The crowd behind them gasps and whispers.

EPISODE 48

67 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 67

Karen Sits down and fans herself to keep from fainting.

KAREN
What? This... how is that possible? How could you like *Shannon*? She's has a, a, she has a--

YANCEY
She has a sugar daddy! If you don't mind second-hand goods, then by all means, pursue her.

Johnny slaps Yancey with an open palm. Everyone watches but nobody lifts a finger to help Yancey.

YANCEY (cont'd)
You hit me!

JOHNNY
Say that again and I'll do worse than hit you. Apologize to Shannon. Right now!

SHANNON
Yancey, are you itching for another 20 mile run?

RICKY
She's not completely wrong. Everyone saw how much you pestered me before. Shannon, am I right?

SHANNON
Ricky Trax, I was blind before, but now you're nothing to me.

RICKY TRAX
You really want to be with Johnny?

Ricky can't hide his hurt and anger. Karen notices and watches very carefully to see what happens next.

SHANNON
And you think I'm obsessed with you? What does it matter if I'm with Johnny or not?

RICKY TRAX
Shannon, what if I gave you a second chance? Would you be my girlfriend again?

Karen can't believe it. Johnny is shocked.

SHANNON
Ricky Trax, do you think you're that important?
(MORE)

SHANNON (CONT'D)
Besides, aren’t you already with Karen? Do you even care how she feels hearing you say that to me?

Karen is about to cry, but having Shannon defend her is too much, too humiliating.

KAREN (V.O.)
Shannon, I will ruin you! In front of the principal and the board members!

Ricky grabs Yancey's popcorn bag and flings it on the floor. Yancey is pissed but doesn't say anything.

Karen runs from the gym.

YANCEY
Karen... Karen!

Ricky turns on Shannon like this was all her fault.

EPISODE 49

68 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 68

Ricky fumes, his anger building. The crowd gives them space. Johnny moves closer to Shannon. Ready to protect her.

RICKY
Shannon, you've gone absolutely too far. I cannot forgive you for this!

SHANNON
I. Don't. Care. About. Your. For. Give. Ness. You. Piece. Of. Shit!

Ricky steps menacingly toward Shannon, she grips Johnny's arms in fear. Johnny balls his fist. Ready to protect Shannon

Ricky doesn't want to get his face bashed in so he storms out. Shannon doesn't let go of Johnny, but she looks confused, studies Johnny's face looking for some sort of answer.

JOHNNY
What’s wrong?

SHANNON
That thing you just said to them.

JOHNNY
Which thing?

SHANNON
You know, when you said you were chasing me...

JOHNNY
Oh, that--

She puts a finger to his lips.

SHANNON
Would you like to know if I want to be caught?

JOHNNY
Of course I want to know!

SHANNON
Well, Boy Wonder, I'm hungry. I'm going to the cafeteria to eat. Do you want to join me?

She doesn't give him a chance to answer and pulls him toward the door.

JOHNNY
That's not an answer!

69 EXT. PARKING LOT - DAY 69

Karen hurries across the parking lot. Ricky rushes out of the boxing gym and runs to catch up with her. He grabs her arm to turn her around but she yanks free.

RICKY
Karen... Karen, don't be upset.

She keeps walking. Keeps avoiding Ricky's hands.

KAREN (V.O.)
Why does Shannon get to be chased by Johnny, while I'm stuck with this nobody?

RICKY
Don't be upset. I only said those things to Shannon to calm her down. I'm not giving her a second chance.

KAREN
I know, I'm just feeling down.

RICKY
Hey, you're the best. Let's stop being upset and let's go eat.

KAREN
Alright. I want to get tapas.

RICKY
Alright. Whatever you want to eat, we'll order it.
(MORE)

RICKY (CONT'D)
Let’s get everything you want, as an apology from me. How about that?

KAREN
Good! And I'm not going to hold back!

She scowls at Ricky and rubs her fingers together indicating: this will be expensive.

EPISODE 50

70 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY 70

Walking through the boxing ym, Shannon still holds onto Johnny's arm. Less hard, more gentle, more affectionate.

JOHNNY
They’re long gone and you're still clinging on for dear life?

SHANNON
What? You don't want me to hold your arm? And here I thought you were pursuing me.

JOHNNY
I am! I really am! Don't you believe me.

SHANNON
I didn’t say I didn’t believe you...

JOHNNY
Well, do I have your permission to pursue you?

SHANNON
You’re so straightforward; I don’t even know what to say.

JOHNNY
Then I’ll take that as a yes. This week at the at your school’s Outstanding Student Award Ceremony, I’ll be attending, and I have a gift I want to give you.

SHANNON (V.O.)
He’s not planning to confess to me on that day, is he, in front of the whole school? It’s too high-profile, way too high-profile.

JOHNNY
I'm going to tutor you so hard you're going to be in the top three.
(MORE)

JOHNNY (CONT'D)
And you're going to give a speech in front all those jerks who have been mean to you. And you know what? They'll have no choice but to acknowledge how great you are. Do you have confidence?

SHANNON
The gift you're talking about is this? I... I have confidence.

JOHNNY
Yes. By the way, stay from the Trax family. I've already investigated all of them and none of them are good people.

SHANNON
I know.

They both walk in silence for a few moments.

SHANNON (V.O.)
In my previous life, that father and son scumbag duo ruined me. In this life, I'm going to send them to hell.

Johnny sees she's deep in thought and getting frustrated.

JOHNNY
Alright, didn't you say you were going to treat me to something?

That snaps her out of it.

SHANNON
Yes, today, whatever super hero tutor Johnny wants to eat, it's on me. Let's go.

EPISODE 51

71 INT. SCHOOL - HALLWAY - DAY 71

The next day.

Ricky and Karen watch as Johnny and Shannon walk into the school staring into each other's eyes, looking like a perfect couple.

KAREN
So shameless.

They see Johnny say something they can't hear to Shannon. They wave goodbye.

Anger consumes Ricky as he watches Shannon watch Johnny leave. Smiling.

He stands angrily and walks toward Shannon.

KAREN (cont'd)
Where are you going? Why are you always running to her!

Ricky grabs Shannon's wrist and drags her into the stairwell.

72 INT. STAIRWELL - DAY 72

Ricky drags Shannon by the hand to a landing.

SHANNON
Let go of me! You're hurting me!

RICKY
Shannon, what's your relationship with Johnny Wonder? Have you two been together this whole time?

He shoves her against the wall, too hard. She's scared and he's furious.

EPISODE 52

73 INT. STAIRWELL - DAY 73

Shannon tries to break free but Ricky shoves her back against the wall.

RICKY
Have you two been together this whole time?

SHANNON
No!

She yanks her arm free.

SHANNON (V.O.)
I wish, but Johnny Wonder is so pure. I'm afraid if I don't take things one step at a time I'll scare him off.

RICKY
I don't believe you, Shannon. I think you're lying to me! You say you're spending time studying with Johnny Wonder, but what are you actually doing?

SHANNON
He's not that kind of person!

RICKY
Fine, I admit it. I had something with Karen before, but I'm serious that I'm serious about you.

SHANNON
You’re upset seeing me so close with Johnny Wonder, aren’t you?

RICKY
Yes! Every time you see him, you’re full of joy. But when you look at me, you never react that way.

She jams a finger into his chest, over his heart.

SHANNON
Here—it hurts, doesn’t it? I used to feel pain here too. I gave everything for you, only to be abused and murdered. Ricky, I will never forget what you did to me, the despair and the pain. I’ll never forget. Everything I've done to you so far...is just the beginning...it'll get worse day by day.

She smiles at him...evilly. Ricky is finally beginning to realize who and what he is dealing with.

EPISODE 53

74 INT. SCHOOL STAIRWELL - DAY 74

Ricky keeps talking but Shannon tries to go around him and get away.

RICKY
Shannon, what are you saying? When did I ever abuse you? Murder? Aren’t you alive and well right now?

Ricky shoves her against the wall trying to kiss her neck. She fights him off.

SHANNON
What are you doing? Let go of me!

RICKY
Shannon, I’m sorry! I'm sorry. I was wrong. I just, I care too much about you.

He doesn't see Johnny coming at him from behind. Not until Johnny grabs his arms and roughly shoves him away from Shannon.

JOHNNY
Didn’t you hear what she said? She said let go.

RICKY
Johnny "Wonder", this is none of your business. I'm talking to Shannon.

JOHNNY
She said let go.

RICKY
What if I don’t? What are you going to do? Hit me? Go ahead, punch me in the mouth. Let’s see who Shannon--

Shannon slaps Ricky.

RICKY (cont'd)
Shannon, you dare hit me?

He looks at Johnny. But Shannon stands in front of him, blocking Ricky's path.

SHANNON
Yeah, I hit you! He shouldn't get his hands dirty touching you.

She takes Johnny's hand in hers and stares at Ricky until he lowers his gaze.

EPISODE 54

75 INT. SCHOOL STAIRWELL - DAY 75

Shannon is fed up. She lets down her prim, polite, demure affect and lets her anger burn through.

SHANNON
I was going to toy around with you. Torture you until you were a pathetic wreck but no. From now on, stay far away from me and Johnny.

Shannon takes Johnny's hand and walks away.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Let’s go.

76 INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - DAY 76

Karen and Yancey chat in the hallway when suddenly Shannon and Johnny rush past holding hands.

Moments later, Ricky comes chasing after them.

KAREN (V.O.)
Shannon, you've ruined my relationship with Ricky. I'm going to make you pay. In front of everyone I'm going to expose you and your sugar daddy in front of everyone! I'm going to RUIN YOU!

77 EXT. SCHOOL - DAY 77

Shannon sits on a bench, very upset, Johnny sits with her.

SHANNON
Another embarrassing scene. I'm sorry you had to witness that...again.

JOHNNY
I'm ashamed I wasn't there sooner. If he hurt you...

SHANNON
He won't. I won't let him hurt me a second time.

JOHNNY
A second time? He hurt you before? I'm sorry, I wasn't then there. From now on...I'll always protect you.

SHANNON
No, it wasn't your fault. It was my own foolishness. Johnny Wonder, thank you. It was a dream, another life, he...killed me. Luckily, I woke up from the dream.

JOHNNY
And in that dream, was I there?

SHANNON
Yes, you were. At the very end of the dream, you came to me.

JOHNNY
And then?

SHANNON
And then? (she smiles) And then I'll tell you after the party is over.

Johnny gasps!

JOHNNY
Oh no, that's right! I almost forgot to congratulate you on becoming your school’s outstanding student representative at this year's awards ceremony.

SHANNON
All because you were such an excellent tutor! And I have a gift for you afterward as well.

JOHNNY
Well, now I’m really looking forward to it!

She leans her shoulder into his and they both smile.

EPISODE 55

78 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY 78

Teacher is at her desk working hard. She sees Karen enter and rolls her eyes, drops her pen: no more work for now!

KAREN
Teacher, why is Shannon the outstanding student representative for this year’s award ceremony? It should be me.

TEACHER
Karen, it should have been you for years, but you always insisted on honoring Ricky.

KAREN
He deserved it.

TEACHER
No, you deserved it but you insisted on giving away your honor to that boy. And this year Shannon has made great progress this year and she deserves it. Her progress is an inspiration to other students.

KAREN
How could they do this? It’s always been me.

TEACHER
I'm sorry. You had plenty of opportunities for this honor and you turned them down. If you have regrets you can talk to the principal but it won't change anything. I'm sorry.

KAREN
I understand.

She walks out and Teacher doesn't even look up.

79 EXT. SCHOOL - DAY 79

Karen storms out of the school.

KAREN (V.O.)
Shannon stole Ricky from me, now she's stealing my honor, what else is she going to take from me?

A luxury car pulls up. Shannon and her father step out. Karen sees them.

KAREN
Oh my god...there they are. Shannon and her sugar daddy!

Karen takes some photos of Shannon adjusting her father's tie and him touching her hair.

KAREN (cont'd)
Shannon, I'm going to ruin you in front of everyone.

80 EXT. CAR - DAY 80

Mr. Clark gives Shannon one last hug.

MR. CLARK
Shannon, my dear, go on inside and get ready. I'm looking forward to your speech.

SHANNON
I'm also excited to hear your speech, Dad. Mr. New Board Member.

She smiles as him and goes inside. He smiles as he watches her go. Such a nice dad.

EPISODE 56

81 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 81

The school auditorium is full, everyone dressed to the nines. The lights dim and the Teacher walks across the stage to the microphone.

TEACHER
Let’s welcome today’s outstanding student representative for the award ceremony, Shannon Clark.

Shannon, in a stunning dress walks out. While she's doing so, her father walks in and takes a seat at the board members table.

SHANNON
Hello everyone, I’m Shannon Clark, today’s student representative. I’m very happy to be here to give this speech. First of all, I’d like to thank—

Suddenly, the microphone cuts out-sending splitting feedback through the auditorium.

A back door opens, Karen boldly steps into the auditorium and projects her voice for all to hear.

KAREN
I have something to report!

With all eyes on her, Karen walks to the stage and stands near Shannon.

KAREN (cont'd)
It has come to my attention that Shannon Clark is not qualified to be the outstanding student representative because she selling herself to an older man.

Hushed whispers through the crowd. Shannon narrows her eyes at Karen, but then her lips form a thin smile.

EPISODE 57

82 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 82

Karen makes her way through the crowd, drawing more eyes and more power with each step. She mounts the stage, and smugly walks to the microphone. Shannon simply watches her come.

KAREN
I've decided to expose Shannon before she can tarnish our school's reputation any more than she already has. She's selling herself, her grades are unnaturally improving, and she treats her classmates with cruelty and malice.

SHANNON
You’re spitting lies! You claim I’m being kept, so show your evidence. If you can’t produce any proof today and slander me in front of the whole school, I’ll sue you to oblivion.

KAREN
Who said I don’t have evidence? Everyone, please look at the big screen.

Photos of Shannon hugging her father are projected on screen. Karen smiles at the audience fully expecting them to be on her side and see things her way.

Shannon only grins.

EPISODE 58

83 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 83

Everyone in the crowd whispers to each other, some dare to speak loud enough for Shannon to hear.

SUE
Oh my goodness, the sugar daddy rumors are true.

Mr. Clark raises an eyebrow at the screen: This is interesting... The PRINCIPAL leans over.

PRINCIPAL
Sir, it seems these students have no idea what they are talking about. I'm sorry. I'll end this right away.

Mr. Clark waves it away and smiles.

MR. CLARK
No need. I’d like to see what these imbiciles think they can accomplish.

Meanwhile on stage, Karen goes in for the kill.

KAREN
See? This is the evidence--

SHANNON
This is the man you claim is keeping me?

KAREN
(projecting for the crowd)
Yes, Shannon. What do you have to say for yourself now?
(MORE)

KAREN (CONT'D)
(for Shannon's ears) Shannon, it must be tough for you. This man is so old and ugly—how could you bring yourself to...be with him?

SHANNON
Shut up! Who says he's old and ugly? In my eyes, he's the most handsome man in the world.

She looks over to Johnny.

SHANNON (cont'd)
Well... second most handsome now.

MR. CLARK
How did I drop to second place?

Karen lifts an eyebrow: see...even he confirms it.

YANCEY
Shannon, you really have no shame, huh? This man who's keeping you—fine, you want his money, but you even have the nerve to call him handsome?

KAREN
She's in love with her sugar daddy!

EPISODE 59

84 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 84

Karen steps away from Shannon, too disgusted to be this close to her.

KAREN
Shannon, you really have no shame. At least have the decency to act embarrassed.

SHANNON
I'm shameless because I called him handsome? What is wrong with you?

KAREN
You're a disgrace to every student here. You're a humiliation.

SHANNON
Karen, if anyone is going to be humiliated today, it's you.

KAREN
Shannon, since you've admitted it, apologize to everyone, and then drop out of school. Maybe you can salvage some dignity.

SHANNON
Karen, you're too kind. That's why people keep walking all over you.

YANCEY
In my opinion, the principal should expel her from the school!

SHANNON
Karen, I would like to know who told you I have a sugar daddy. You have photos, but who really tipped you off? Do you have any other witnesses?

KAREN
Of course I have a witness!

YANCEY
Ricky Trax told us. We all believe him! Tell her what you told us!

Ricky Trax knows he's doomed and wishes this would all go away...but it's not so he's going to get burned.

EPISODE 60

85 INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY 85

The lights come on in the auditorium but everyone is looking at Ricky.

SUE
Isn't it true? Come on, Ricky Trax, say something! Is it true or not?

SHANNON
Is this the witness you're talking about? C'mon Ricky, tell everyone what kind of relationship I have with this man.

RICKY
The pictures are blurry; I can't tell what I'm looking at.

SHANNON
Ricky, this is your last chance to explain everything to everyone.

YANCEY
Shannon, why are you dragging Ricky into this? It's bad enough you've lost your shame, but now you're trying to pull someone else down with you.

KAREN
Shannon, I know you've always liked Ricky, but even so, you can't make him lie for you.

YANCEY
Karen is right. Shannon, it's embarrassing to be your classmate. If you have any self-respect, you should just drop out.

SHANNON
You want me to drop out?

YANCEY
What do you all say, classmates? If she doesn't drop out, are we really going to let this kind of scum stay at our school?

STUDENTS
Drop out! Drop out! Drop out!

PRINCIPAL
Everyone, shut up! It's time to put an end to this bullshit!

EPISODE 61

86 INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY 86

The Principal walks on stage. Dude is pissed.

KAREN
Principal, please stand up for us. Shannon all the evidence points to her having a sugar daddy and being a bully. Please kick her out, she's a disgrace.

PRINCIPAL
A disgrace?

KAREN
Principal, with the new board member coming to this ceremony today, you have to handle Shannon properly for the school's reputation.

PRINCIPAL
Indeed. Improper behavior must be punished. So, tell me, what do you think should be done with someone who lacks good character? How should I, as the principal, handle this?

YANCEY
Shannon, did you hear that? The principal is about to deal with you. Principal, I suggest that she be expelled from the school. We don’t need someone like her here.

PRINCIPAL
Yancey, are you sure? You're in your final year of university. If someone from your class is expelled, they won't receive a diploma, and all these years of study will have been for nothing.

YANCEY
So what? That’s the price she pays for doing something wrong. If Shannon dared to do this, she should be punished severely as a warning to others. Otherwise, we might as well call this place a brothel, not a university.

PRINCIPAL
So, you all agree that someone with improper conduct, who harms fellow students and tarnishes the school's reputation, should be expelled. Is that right?

He stares down the students.

EPISODE 62

87 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 87

Yancey stands up, projects her voice so everyone can hear. She speaks like she's trying to whip up a mob.

YANCEY
No doubt about it, we must expel this disgusting person..

PRINCIPAL
Shannon, what do you think?

SHANNON
The truth shall set me free.

KAREN
Principal, I don’t think it’s necessary to expel Shannon just yet. We should give her a chance to admit her mistake in front of everyone. IF she kneels and apologizes perhaps the students could forgive her.

SHANNON
You want me to kneel and apologize to everyone? Won’t that just ruin my reputation even more?

RICKY
Shannon, after all this trouble just apologize and end it. Things an go back to normal.

SHANNON
Apologize? Ricky, why don’t you tell them what exactly what's going on and who that man is to me. Or better yet, why don’t you start by revealing who you really are?

RICKY
What does my identity have to do with you?

SHANNON
You’re too scared to say it? Fine, I’ll say it for you. Ricky Trax is the son of a CHAUFFEUR. MY chauffeur! He's a poor boy trying to spend my money to look cool for you idiots.

EPISODE 63

88 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 88

Sue gets out of her seat, moves down a few rows so she can see and hear better.

SUE
What? Ricky is the son of a driver? Shannon really did pay for his birthday and he lied saying it was his card all along.

RICKY
Shannon! I'm giving you one last warning. I know you want me but this is pushing me away. I can't tolerate much more--

During Ricky's speech, Johnny climbs onto the stage and punches Ricky.

RICKY (cont'd)
How dare you hit me!

Ricky tries to stand but Johnny kicks him to the ground. Shannon lifts her dress and kicks Ricky.

MR. CLARK
Ricky Trax, the Clark family practically raised you! But you are an ungrateful scum-bag. Just like your father.

KAREN
That's him, Principal! He's Shannon's sugar daddy! She's sleeping with a board member!

Poor Karen, she has no idea she's in for a world of hurt. But Shannon knows...

Karen saunters up to Mr. Clark. She's forced to look up at him, but that doesn't stop her from jabbing a finger into his chest to punctuate each sentence.

KAREN (cont'd)
What do you think will happen when it gets out that you're sleeping with a student? What will your family think?

PRINCIPAL
Karen, shut up! Do you even know who he is?

KAREN
Principal, it doesn't matter who he is. He's sleeping with a student. We don't need his kind on the board. He should be in jail.

PRINCIPAL
Shut up.

MR. CLARK
Shannon, come here.

She stands next to her father as he addresses the audience.

MR. CLARK (cont'd)
Let me introduce myself to everyone. I am Reginald Clark, your school's new board member, the head of alumni relations and on the state board of business affairs. Shannon is my daughter, whom I have cherished and protected for twenty years, never allowing her to suffer the slightest grievance, but who you saw fit to insult and slander.

KAREN
This... this can't be true!
Principal, he must be an impostor!

PRINCIPAL
Karen, just stop talking!

KAREN
This can't be happening. What's going on here? What's going on here?

MR. CLARK
You were all saying earlier that those who have poor morals, harm students, and damage the school's reputation should be expelled, right? Principal?

PRINCIPAL
Yes, yes, yes.

MR. CLARK
Since you've already set the rules, then those who spread rumors about me and my daughter should be expelled.

PRINCIPAL
Yes.

Yancey runs to the stage to beg.

YANCEY
Mr. Clark, sir, it's not like that. We didn't know Shannon was your daughter. I didn't do it on purpose.

MR. CLARK
Not on purpose? You mean, you didn't know?

Yancey nods sheepishly, banking on his mercy.

EPISODE 64

89 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 89

MR. CLARK
Are you a child? Are you stupid? To every student who went along with abusing my daughter, you will never work in this city. And the ringleaders, Karen, Ricky, and Yancey...well, if I were you, I'd look into plane tickets out of this city as soon as possible.

The crowd gasps. This is unbelievable.

Yancey collapses on stage realizing she just effed up her entire life. I mean...damn, what a doofus.

YANCEY
It’s over, everything’s over.

KAREN
Mr. Clark, even if the rumors about you aren’t true, there’s no denying that Shannon used your money to keep Johnny as a boy toy.

MR. CLARK
You're saying my daughter bought Johnny? Johnny Wonder?

KAREN
That’s right. You should see how she dangles herself all over him.

MR. CLARK
I really didn’t know the Clark family had so much influence and power and money to buy Johnny Wonder. You know who he is, right?

KAREN
What?

MR. CLARK
You've heard of the Boy Prince? Heir to largest conglomerate in the city? The family that owns almost every downtown building. That's Johnny Wonder, he's the Boy Prince.

Karen's face drops. So does everyone's.

MR. CLARK (cont'd)
(to Johnny)
With all due respect. (Johnny nods in approval) He frickin OWNS THE CITY!

KAREN
What? Johnny is the Boy Prince? That’s impossible, it can’t be. He wouldn’t possibly like Shannon. This isn’t possible.

RICKY
What did you say? No way, I don’t believe it. He can't be...

JOHNNY
You two are as good as dead, so whether you believe it or not makes no difference.

Johnny snaps his fingers and SIX GUARDS rush inside: grab Ricky and Karen, shove gags in their mouths and drag them away.

KAREN/RICKY
Let go of me, let go of me! What are you doing? What are you doing? Let me go!

JOHNNY
Mr. Clark, these two are incredibly malicious, and they've shown they are horrible people willing to go great lengths to hurt Shannon. Please allow me to handle this in my own way.

Mr. Clark nods in approval.

JOHNNY (cont'd)
Shannon, I mentioned before that I wanted to give you a gift at the awards ceremony.

SHANNON
Let me speak first.

EPISODE 65

90 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT 90

SHANNON
Johnny, I'm very grateful that you came into my life. At first, my feelings for you were mixed with gratitude, but over time, I couldn't help but fall in love with you. We've missed so much time together, and I don't want to waste any more. Let's get married right away.

JOHNNY
How can a girl be the one to propose?

Johnny looks at Mr. Clark for a moment. Mr. Clark nods and Johnny smiles. Then drops to one knee and pulls a small box from his coat.

Shannon covers her mouth in shock and joy.

JOHNNY (cont'd)
Shannon, I missed you once before, but I won't lose you in this life. And in this life I will never let you suffer.

SHANNON
You remember too?

FLASHBACK to THE DINGY MOTEL while she is dying in Johnny's arms.

JOHNNY
Shannon, if there's a next life I will never let you suffer.

91 EXT. SHANNON'S PENTHOUSE - NIGHT (FLASHBACK) 91

Shannon stares at Johnny.

JOHNNY
Miss Clark, it’s wonderful to see you.

92 INT. BOXING GYM - DAY (FLASHBACK) 92

Shannon puts a finger to Johnny's lips.

SHANNON
Would you like to know if I want to be caught?

93 EXT. SCHOOL - DAY (FLASHBACK) 93

Shannon sits on a bench, very upset, Johnny sits next to her.

JOHNNY
A second time? He hurt you before? I’m sorry, I wasn't then there. From now on...I'll always protect you.

94 INT. AUDITORIUM - NIGHT (PRESENT) 94

Shannon looks down at Johnny on one knee. She adores him.

JOHNNY
Will you marry me?

SHANNON
I will. In this life and every other.

Everyone claps and smiles. Even the students who were mean to her before. Except the ones who were dragged out to be murdered.

Johnny lifts her off her feet and spins her. They finally kiss.

SHANNON (V.O.)
Thank you, Johnny. Thank you, universe for this second chance. heaven.

SHANNON
Johnny Wonder, I'm willing to be your wife, to honor you and love you forever.

The audience cheers.

The End